

VOCABULARY · EXAMPLES · ACTIVITIES

TRAVEL DICTIONARY

El diccionario del viajero

The words you need from the airport to the beach,
with Spain 🇪🇸 and Argentina 🇦🇷 vocabulary

PONCHO Spanish

¡HOLA, VIAJERO!

Every trip is a chance to use Spanish for real: reading a sign, buying a ticket, asking a local where the best beach is.

This dictionary collects more than 80 travel words and expressions, each with a real example sentence, so you can see how people actually use them. At the end you'll find activities to check what you remember.

Take it with you, look things up on the go and don't worry about mistakes. Trying is what turns a holiday into a conversation.

How to use it

1. **Read the word, then the sentence.** Words stick better when you see them in action.
2. **Say it out loud.** Even quietly on the bus, your mouth needs the practice.
3. **Spot the words on your trip:** signs, menus, tickets and announcements are full of them.
4. **Try the activities** without looking back, then check the answers.

Two countries, two words

Spanish is spoken in more than 20 countries and travel words change a lot from place to place. When you see two options, the first is common in Spain 🇪🇸 and the second in Argentina 🇦🇷. Both are correct.

la maleta 🇪🇸 = **la valija** 🇦🇷

El or la?

Every Spanish noun is masculine (**el**) or feminine (**la**). Learn the little word together with the noun: **el billete**, **la playa**, **el mapa**. Yes, **el mapa** is masculine even though it ends in -a!

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01

PREPARAR EL VIAJE

PLANNING THE TRIP

Bookings, documents and everything that goes in the case.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el viaje	the trip, the journey	*El viaje dura dos semanas.* The trip lasts two weeks.
las vacaciones	the holidays	*Nos vamos de vacaciones en agosto.* We're going on holiday in August.
reservar	to book	*Hay que reservar el hotel pronto.* We need to book the hotel soon.
la reserva	the booking	*Tengo la reserva en el móvil.* I've got the booking on my phone.
el pasaporte	the passport	*No olvides el pasaporte.* Don't forget your passport.
el seguro de viaje	travel insurance	*Compramos un seguro de viaje.* We bought travel insurance.
la maleta 🇪🇸 la valija 🇦🇷	the suitcase	*Mi maleta pesa demasiado.* My suitcase is too heavy.
la mochila	the rucksack	*Llevo el agua en la mochila.* I carry the water in my rucksack.
hacer la maleta 🇪🇸 armar la valija 🇦🇷	to pack	*Esta noche hago la maleta.* I'm packing tonight.
el cargador	the charger	*¿Has metido el cargador?* Have you packed the charger?
el adaptador	the adaptor	*Necesitamos un adaptador para el enchufe.* We need an adaptor for the plug.

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01 · PREPARAR EL VIAJE PLANNING THE TRIP

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la crema solar 🇪🇸 el protector solar 🇦🇷	sun cream	*Ponte crema solar antes de salir.* Put sun cream on before you go out.
las gafas de sol 🇪🇸 los anteojos de sol 🇦🇷	sunglasses	*¿Dónde están mis gafas de sol?* Where are my sunglasses?
el destino	the destination	*Nuestro destino es Mendoza.* Our destination is Mendoza.
el itinerario	the itinerary	*El itinerario está en la nevera.* The itinerary is on the fridge.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Holidays are always plural in Spanish: las vacaciones. You'll never hear una vacación. And the summer holidays in Argentina are in January and February, when it's summer in the southern hemisphere!

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02

EL TRANSPORTE

TRANSPORT

Planes, trains, buses and cars, and the tickets that go with them.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el avión	the plane	*El avión aterriza a las seis.* The plane lands at six.
el aeropuerto	the airport	*Llegamos al aeropuerto muy temprano.* We got to the airport really early.
el tren	the train	*El tren de alta velocidad es muy cómodo.* The high-speed train is very comfortable.
el andén	the platform	*El tren sale del andén tres.* The train leaves from platform three.
el autobús 🇪🇸 el colectivo 🇦🇷	the bus	*Cogemos el autobús en la plaza.* We get the bus in the square.
el autocar 🇪🇸 el micro 🇦🇷	the coach	*Fuimos a Córdoba en micro.* We went to Córdoba by coach.
el metro 🇪🇸 el subte 🇦🇷	the underground	*El metro cierra a medianoche.* The underground closes at midnight.
el coche 🇪🇸 el auto 🇦🇷	the car	*Alquilamos un coche para ir a la costa.* We hired a car to go to the coast.
el barco	the boat, the ship	*Cruzamos el río en barco.* We crossed the river by boat.
la bici	the bike	*Recorrimos la ciudad en bici.* We went round the city by bike.
el billete 🇪🇸 el boleto 🇦🇷	the ticket	*He comprado los billetes por internet.* I bought the tickets online.

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02 · EL TRANSPORTE TRANSPORT

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el horario	the timetable	*Mira el horario de los trenes.* Check the train timetable.
conducir 🇪🇸 manejar 🇦🇷	to drive	*Mi madre conduce por la derecha.* My mum drives on the right.
la gasolina 🇪🇸 la nafta 🇦🇷	petrol	*Tenemos que poner gasolina.* We need to get petrol.
perder el tren	to miss the train	*¡Corre, que perdemos el tren!* Run, we're going to miss the train!

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

In Argentina a long-distance coach is el micro, and some have seats that recline almost flat, called cama, like a bed. Many travellers cross the country overnight on them.

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03

EL ALOJAMIENTO

WHERE TO STAY

Hotels, hostels, flats and campsites, and what you'll find inside.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el hotel	the hotel	*El hotel está al lado de la playa.* The hotel is next to the beach.
el albergue 🇪🇸 el hostel 🇦🇷	the hostel	*Dormimos en un albergue juvenil.* We slept in a youth hostel.
el apartamento 🇪🇸 el departamento 🇦🇷	the flat	*Alquilamos un apartamento con terraza.* We rented a flat with a terrace.
el camping	the campsite	*El camping tiene piscina.* The campsite has a swimming pool.
la tienda de campaña 🇪🇸 la carpa 🇦🇷	the tent	*Montamos la tienda de campaña bajo un árbol.* We put the tent up under a tree.
la recepción	reception	*Deja la llave en recepción.* Leave the key at reception.
la habitación	the room	*La habitación es pequeña pero bonita.* The room is small but pretty.
la cama	the bed	*Hay dos camas y un sofá.* There are two beds and a sofa.
la almohada	the pillow	*¿Me da otra almohada?* Could I have another pillow?
la ducha	the shower	*La ducha no tiene agua caliente.* The shower has no hot water.
la piscina 🇪🇸 la pileta 🇦🇷	the swimming pool	*Los niños están en la piscina.* The children are in the swimming pool.

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03 · EL ALOJAMIENTO WHERE TO STAY

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
las vistas	the view	*¡Qué vistas tan bonitas!* What a beautiful view!
el aire acondicionado	air conditioning	*Con este calor, necesitamos aire acondicionado.* In this heat, we need air conditioning.
completo	full, no vacancies	*Lo siento, el hotel está completo.* Sorry, the hotel is full.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

In Spain un parador is a hotel inside a historic building: castles, monasteries and palaces. In Argentina, una estancia is a big country ranch, and some welcome visitors to stay, ride horses and share an asado.

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04

EN LA CIUDAD

AROUND TOWN

Places to visit, places you need, and how to find them.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el centro	the town centre	*Vamos andando al centro.* Let's walk into the centre.
la plaza	the square	*La plaza está llena de gente.* The square is full of people.
la calle	the street	*Mi hotel está en esta calle.* My hotel is on this street.
la acera 🇪🇸 la vereda 🇦🇷	the pavement	*Camina por la acera, no por la calle.* Walk on the pavement, not in the road.
el semáforo	the traffic lights	*Espera a que el semáforo esté en verde.* Wait until the lights are green.
el museo	the museum	*El museo es gratis los domingos.* The museum is free on Sundays.
la catedral	the cathedral	*La catedral es del siglo XV.* The cathedral is from the fifteenth century.
el mercado	the market	*En el mercado venden fruta fresca.* They sell fresh fruit at the market.
la oficina de turismo	the tourist information office	*Pide un mapa en la oficina de turismo.* Ask for a map at the tourist office.
el mapa	the map	*Según el mapa, estamos aquí.* According to the map, we're here.
el cajero automático	the cashpoint	*Hay un cajero automático en la esquina.* There's a cashpoint on the corner.

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04 · EN LA CIUDAD AROUND TOWN

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
los aseos 🇪🇸 el baño 🇦🇷	the toilets	*Perdone, ¿dónde están los aseos?* Excuse me, where are the toilets?
la playa	the beach	*La playa está a diez minutos.* The beach is ten minutes away.
la manzana 🇪🇸 la cuadra 🇦🇷	the block	*Está a dos manzanas.* It's two blocks away.
perderse	to get lost	*Nos perdimos en el casco antiguo.* We got lost in the old town.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Buenos Aires is laid out in a grid, so people measure distances in cuadras: 'está a cinco cuadras' means it's five blocks away. Each cuadra is about 100 metres, which makes it easy to work out how far you need to walk.

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05

COMER FUERA

EATING OUT

Cafés, bars and restaurants, from breakfast to the bill.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el restaurante	the restaurant	*Este restaurante es muy famoso.* This restaurant is very famous.
la cafetería 🇪🇸 el café 🇦🇷	the café	*Desayunamos en una cafetería.* We had breakfast in a café.
la carta	the menu	*¿Nos trae la carta, por favor?* Could you bring us the menu, please?
el camarero 🇪🇸 el mozo 🇦🇷	the waiter	*El camarero es muy simpático.* The waiter is really friendly.
pedir	to order	*¿Ya habéis pedido?* Have you ordered yet?
el desayuno	breakfast	*El desayuno es a las nueve.* Breakfast is at nine.
la comida 🇪🇸 el almuerzo 🇦🇷	lunch	*La comida está lista.* Lunch is ready.
la cena	dinner	*La cena en España es muy tarde.* Dinner in Spain is very late.
las tapas 🇪🇸 la picada 🇦🇷	snacks to share	*Pedimos unas tapas para compartir.* We ordered some tapas to share.
el plato del día	the dish of the day	*Hoy el plato del día es pescado.* Today's special is fish.
el vaso	the glass	*¿Me da un vaso de agua?* Could I have a glass of water?

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05 · COMER FUERA EATING OUT

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la cuenta	the bill	*¿Nos trae la cuenta, por favor?* Could you bring us the bill, please?
la propina	the tip	*Dejamos una propina en la mesa.* We left a tip on the table.
para llevar	to take away	*Dos cafés para llevar.* Two coffees to take away.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

In much of Spain, tapas are small plates to share, and in some cities like Granada a free tapa comes with every drink. In Argentina, a board of cheese, cold meats and olives to share before a meal is una picada.

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06

PROBLEMAS Y EMERGENCIAS

PROBLEMS AND EMERGENCIES

When something goes wrong, these words help you put it right.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la emergencia	the emergency	*En caso de emergencia, llama al 112.* In an emergency, call 112.
¡Socorro! / ¡Ayuda!	Help!	*¡Socorro! ¡Mi amigo se ha caído!* Help! My friend has fallen!
el médico	the doctor	*Necesito ver a un médico.* I need to see a doctor.
la farmacia	the chemist's	*La farmacia de guardia está abierta.* The out-of-hours chemist's is open.
el hospital	the hospital	*Lo llevaron al hospital.* They took him to hospital.
la policía	the police	*Hay que avisar a la policía.* We need to tell the police.
robar	to steal, to rob	*Me robaron el móvil en la playa.* My phone was stolen on the beach.
perder	to lose	*He perdido la tarjeta del hotel.* I've lost the hotel key card.
la cartera 🇪🇸 la billetera 🇦🇷	the wallet	*Mi cartera está en el coche.* My wallet is in the car.
el móvil 🇪🇸 el celular 🇦🇷	the mobile phone	*No tengo batería en el móvil.* My phone's out of battery.
roto	broken	*La maleta llegó rota.* The suitcase arrived broken.

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06 · PROBLEMAS Y EMERGENCIAS PROBLEMS AND EMERGENCIES

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
enfermo	ill	*Mi hermana está enferma.* My sister is ill.
la embajada	the embassy	*La embajada británica está en el centro.* The British embassy is in the centre.
la quemadura de sol	sunburn	*Tengo una quemadura de sol en la espalda.* I've got sunburn on my back.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Spanish chemists display a green cross, and there is always one farmacia de guardia open at night in each area. The address of the one on duty is posted on the door of every chemist's.

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07

FRASES DE VIAJE

TRAVEL PHRASES

Short, useful sentences for every stage of the trip. When there are two versions, the second is how you'd say it in Argentina.

¿Dónde está la estación?
Where's the station?

¿A qué hora sale el tren?
What time does the train leave?

Un billete de ida y vuelta. / Un boleto de ida y vuelta.
A return ticket.

¿Está lejos de aquí? / ¿Está lejos de acá?
Is it far from here?

¿Me lo puede escribir?
Could you write it down for me?

¿Hay wifi?
Is there wifi?

¿Cuánto cuesta? / ¿Cuánto sale?
How much is it?

Tengo una reserva.
I have a booking.

¿Me hace una foto? / ¿Me saca una foto?
Could you take a photo of me?

¿Qué me recomienda visitar?
What do you recommend visiting?

Estoy perdido. / Estoy perdida.
I'm lost.

¡Qué bonito! / ¡Qué lindo!
How lovely!

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

'¡Qué lindo!' is everywhere in Argentina: a view, a dog, a song or a person can all be lindo. In Spain you'll hear '¡qué bonito!' much more often.

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08

¡A VIAJAR!

ACTIVITIES

1 MATCH THEM UP

Write the letter of the English meaning next to each Spanish word or phrase.

1	el andén	☐	A	the pavement
2	la acera	☐	B	the charger
3	el semáforo	☐	C	the menu
4	la almohada	☐	D	the platform
5	el horario	☐	E	to get lost
6	el cargador	☐	F	the timetable
7	la carta	☐	G	the bill
8	la cuenta	☐	H	the traffic lights
9	el seguro de viaje	☐	I	travel insurance
10	perderse	☐	J	the pillow

2 ¿VERDADERO O FALSO?

Read each sentence and circle V (true) or F (false).

1. El andén es donde esperas el tren. **V** **F**
2. Una tienda de campaña es un tipo de restaurante. **V** **F**
3. En Argentina, la piscina se llama pileta. **V** **F**
4. La cena es la comida de la mañana. **V** **F**
5. Si el hotel está completo, no hay habitaciones libres. **V** **F**
6. El mapa es una palabra femenina: la mapa. **V** **F**

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3 POSTCARD FROM SPAIN

Complete the postcard with the words from the box.

avión · maleta · habitación · playa · museo · tapas · perdimos · vistas

¡Hola, Sam! Llegamos a Málaga en _____ el lunes, pero mi _____ llegó un día tarde. Nuestra _____ del hotel tiene unas _____ increíbles al mar. Por la mañana vamos a la _____ y por la tarde visitamos el _____ Picasso. Ayer nos _____ en el casco antiguo, ¡pero encontramos un bar con unas _____ riquísimas! Un abrazo.

4 SPAIN OR ARGENTINA?

Write the word used in Argentina next to the one used in Spain.

- **el coche** → _____
- **la acera** → _____
- **conducir** → _____
- **la gasolina** → _____
- **la piscina** → _____
- **la manzana** → _____
- **la tienda de campaña** → _____
- **el apartamento** → _____

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5 SOPA DE LETRAS

Find the 12 words. They go across → or down ↓.

E	R	O	M	B	C	T	U	L	L	M	V
R	U	P	U	C	C	I	R	C	B	J	U
P	J	N	S	M	B	V	I	A	J	E	A
P	P	M	E	F	I	V	T	D	R	B	G
L	J	E	O	H	C	N	R	C	A	M	A
A	N	R	C	F	I	P	E	N	T	I	E
Y	H	O	T	E	L	O	N	T	I	O	M
A	N	H	E	C	M	A	P	A	F	E	H
H	P	L	A	Z	A	B	A	R	C	O	A
A	V	I	O	N	R	U	F	I	J	A	E
O	T	M	V	U	L	E	S	V	B	P	T
N	D	U	C	H	A	N	N	N	D	R	N

VIAJE
AVION
TREN
PLAYA
MAPA
HOTEL
BARCO
MUSEO
PLAZA
CAMA
BICI
DUCHA

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6 YOUR DREAM TRIP

Describe your dream trip to a Spanish-speaking country in four or five sentences: where you'd go, how you'd travel, where you'd stay and what you'd do. Use at least six words from this dictionary.

Try: Mi viaje ideal es a... Viajaría en... Me quedaría en... Por la mañana... y por la tarde...

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ANSWERS

1 · MATCH THEM UP

1–D, 2–A, 3–H, 4–J, 5–F, 6–B, 7–C, 8–G, 9–I, 10–E

2 · ¿VERDADERO O FALSO?

1 V, 2 F, 3 V, 4 F, 5 V, 6 F

3 · POSTCARD FROM SPAIN

1. avión, 2. maleta, 3. habitación, 4. vistas, 5. playa, 6. museo, 7. perdimos, 8. tapas

4 · SPAIN OR ARGENTINA?

el coche → el auto; la acera → la vereda; conducir → manejar; la gasolina → la nafta; la piscina → la pileta; la manzana → la cuadra; la tienda de campaña → la carpa; el apartamento → el departamento

6 · YOUR DREAM TRIP

Any answer that uses six words from the dictionary is a perfect trip. Read it out loud!

5 · SOPA DE LETRAS

E	R	O	M	B	C	T	U	L	L	M	V
R	U	P	U	C	C	I	R	C	B	J	U
P	J	N	S	M	B	V	I	A	J	E	A
P	P	M	E	F	I	V	T	D	R	B	G
L	J	E	O	H	C	N	R	C	A	M	A
A	N	R	C	F	I	P	E	N	T	I	E
Y	H	O	T	E	L	O	N	T	I	O	M
A	N	H	E	C	M	A	P	A	F	E	H
H	P	L	A	Z	A	B	A	R	C	O	A
A	V	I	O	N	R	U	F	I	J	A	E
O	T	M	V	U	L	E	S	V	B	P	T
N	D	U	C	H	A	N	N	N	D	R	N

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¡BUEN VIAJE!

YOU'RE READY

You now have the words for the whole journey. Keep this dictionary in your bag and see how many you can use on your next trip.

PONCHO SPANISH

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